

There was never a clear winner in the battle for supremacy between the SNES and the Genesis. Both stayed neck and neck till the next generation of consoles rendered them both obsolete.

What is interesting is the fact that Nintendo had approached Sony to develop a CD add-on for the SNES in 1988. Nintendo later backed out of the project due to a dispute regarding sharing of licensing revenues. The add-on was supposed to be named PlayStation, and Sony stuck to that name when they came out with their own console, just to spite Nintendo.

The Jaguar, a cartridge based console was one of the last consoles to be released by Atari, in 1993. It consisted of five processor chips, two of which were 64-bit. Thus, some recognise it as the very first 64-bit system, while others dispute that claim. In any case, it was much more powerful than most other consoles at the time. Unfortunately it did nothing to improve the fortunes of Atari, basically because of the lack of game titles.

The Sega Saturn was released in 1995 and paved the way for the Sony PlayStation. It showed the world that a console could be CD-based but affordable and fun at the same time. Sega and Sony were at war with each other at the time, and Sega beat Sony to the finish line by releasing their Saturn before Sony could release their PlayStation—or so it seemed. When Sony did release the PlayStation, it became a phenomenal success. To put it simply, it blew all the competition into orbit! The Saturn was no exception and could do nothing to beat the PlayStation.

Although released a year after the PlayStation, the Nintendo 64 (N64) was the last mainstream console to use cartridges to store games. This did have its advantages: load times were non-existent compared to CDs; cartridges were difficult to manufacture and/or duplicate, piracy declined; and the biggest advantage of cartridges was that they stored information such as user profiles and saved games. This eliminated the need for memory cards that were a must with CD-based consoles.